

The Samsung X700 also has a very good display with excellent clarity and crispness, maybe more so than the 6630. Views differed about a winner, leading to some heated arguments, followed by more testing, until the decision was made, they're both good! The Sony Ericsson K750i, W550i and Nokia 3230 all deserve a mention here. As mentioned above, the X700 has a brilliant display, one sore point is it could have been a bit larger, (one reason why it lost a couple of points to the larger screen Nokia), which is the same gripe with the K750i. This is one area where scoring was very difficult, kudos to manufacturers for improving the screen quality many fold for the current generation phones.

Coming to MP3 playback quality, which is one of the selling points of multimedia cell phones these days, the winner is the Sony Ericsson W550i. This phone is part of Sony's 'Walkman' series, and features stereo widening, (a DSP effect), which greatly enhances sound clarity and volume. Unlike some of the other phones, the W550i can go really loud, without distortion and we're talking without the headphones! When you plug these in, its like listening to a mini concert, they're really so good. Nothing else comes close! Not in this price category, or for that matter any other. If MP3 *masti* is all you really want out of your cell, (apart from the cell phone features that is), you can blindly get the W550i! The only pain will be, as we mentioned the lack of expansion.

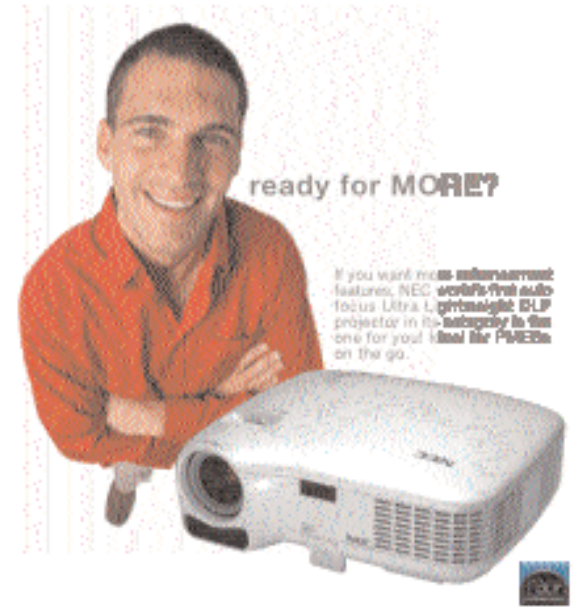
Second place goes to the K750i, which although a tad shy on the volume, (as compared to its musically brilliant companion above), is high on quality and fidelity. These two Sony Ericsson phones were in a league of their own, as far as music playback goes. The Nokia 6630 and 3230 make a decent showing here, with stereo playback, they both sound more than decent with headphones, and clarity is good, it just ain't got the decibels! The Siemens SL75 along with the 6260 brought up the rear, with the Nokia 6260 sounding pathetic, not loud enough, and with distortion even with the earplugs on. Being an earlier model is an excuse, but look past the 6260 if MP3 playback is important to you.

Another area in which phones in this category are supposed to deliver is storage capacity i.e. expandability. Not much use having a great camera and MP3 player if you cannot store more than a few numbers of video clips right?

The Sony Ericsson W550i and the Siemens SL75 were the only two cellphones in this range that didn't come with any memory expansion. This is a definite minus point considering the need for storing all that multimedia content. The W550i does have a very respectable 256 MB onboard—which is quite a lot for a cell phone, and more than enough for a few MP3's and videos. All other cell phones had expansion in the form of memory cards, with capacities up to 1 GB. Nokia's latest cell phones have support dual volt RSDMMC, (or Reduced Size Multi Media Cards), which are around half the size of an MMC card. Sony Ericsson's cellphones that have expansion slots feature the Memory Stick Duo—a Sony proprietary memory card. The Philips 768 featured a Mini SD memory slot, while the

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